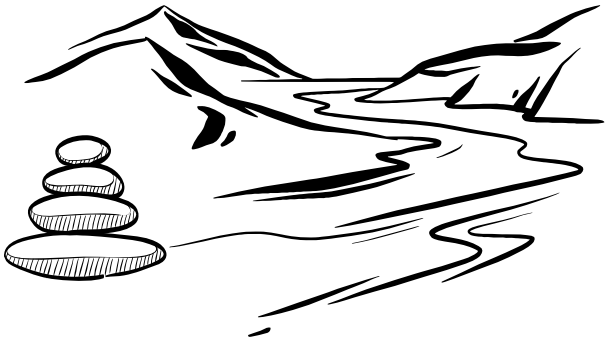


MEMORIAL STONES

Throughout scripture God calls His people to create memorial stones or *"ebenezers"* to remind themselves of His character and deeds, so that they can continue to persevere in loving and following Him. We also want to be people of remembrance and perseverance. Read the following verses and make observations:

Deuteronomy 6:1-12 **[The Importance of Remembering]**

- Why is it important to remember the Lord and His deeds?
- How are people called to remember?

Joshua 4:1-9, 19-24 **[An Example of a Memorial Stone]**

- Why was the memorial significant? What did it teach them about God?

Judges 2:10-13 **[Warning Against Forgetting]**

- What was the result of Israel forgetting the Lord?

How has God been revealing Himself and developing you?

Work through the following steps to help identify some of your own memorial stones and life lessons.

Step 1 - Identifying Your Memorial Stones

Identify both positive and negative memorial stones—people, circumstances, and events that God has used to shape your life. Consider, but do not limit yourself to, some of the following categories:

Crisis/Losses/Pain	Parents, significant relatives
Defeats/Failure	Conflicts
Victories	Successes/Blessings
Adverse circumstances	Meaningful scripture, promises
Friends, mentors	Major decisions

Be sure to spend time in prayer. Ask God to reveal to you elements of your life that could establish patterns as to how He has developed you and/or taught you about Himself.

Step 2 - Reflecting on Life Lessons

Pray and ask God for insight into what He might have been saying to you or teaching you. Feel the freedom to work on this over the course of a set period of time, not just in one sitting.

1. Referring to your timeline, identify 3-5 key memorial stones. Focus on a person, event, or circumstance, not a period of time.
2. Reflect on how God used the experience and how you experienced Him. List what you learned in the Life Lessons column.
3. Identify the biblical concept in what He was teaching you. What scriptures are tied to this concept? List the Biblical concept and scripture in their respective columns.

Step 3 - Crystallizing Life Lessons

1. Review the lessons and phrase them to make them easy to remember - alliteration, rhyme, short phrase, etc.
2. Consider if there are Themes - the Lord may reveal some themes in how you have experienced Him and His work in your life. As you become aware of them, add these to your worksheet.
3. Share your life lessons with others to get their feedback.
4. Periodically come back to your timeline and see if God will grant you insight into life lessons from other memorial stones.

MEMORIAL STONES

Step 1: Personal Memorial Stones (Example)

Timeframe	Favorable people, events, etc	Difficult people, events, etc
Freshmen year	Bible study; friendship with *S	Break-up; Halloween partying
Sophomore year	SF trip with *R; study abroad	Roommate conflict; SHAW study
Junior year	sister reading Bible; missions trip	Grandma's death; mental health issues
Senior year	Sister dinners; discipling *L	Relationship with *E; discerning future

Step 2-3: Life Lessons Exercise (Example)

Memorial Stones	Biblical Concept	Life Lesson	Biblical Passage
1| Deciding to do freshmen Bible study	Guidance	You Jesus, have good things planned for me	Ephesians 2:10; Isaiah 30:21
2| Break-up freshmen year	Chosen by You	Necessary to experience better things you had for me	Ephesians 1:4-5
3| Teaching sister how to read the Bible	You pursue people	You invite me to pray for and invest in others	1 Thess 2:8
Theme - God, you are faithful to protect and choose me.			

Reflection & Application

- How does this impact your relationship Jesus? Your ministry to others?
- How will these lessons help you persevere in this next season of life?
- How could you integrate or share these life lessons with others in your life and ministry?

This journal was made by the University of Arizona Navigators staff in 2020, with the latest update in 2025, and is meant to be shared. Please do not reproduce for profit.

For reproduction, corrections, suggestions for improvement, or to request a digital copy please email Ryan Mullarkey at ryan.mullarkey@navigators.org